Constitution of this country, but the Constitution of any country in which people are anxious to retain freedom and liberty of thought and action. I therefore ask the Prime Minister that he should be true to his word. If he really does not want to hurry, then, he should accept our proposal. Let the time be two weeks or three weeks; it does not matter. But, let the public of India have this impression that when this first great step is being taken by the Government to amend the Constitution, there is no indecent or undue haste followed by the Government of the day.

How was the Constitution framed? We spent nearly four years to frame this Constitution. It was not hurriedly done. Take this Chapter on Fundamental Rights. A special committee was appointed of which the Prime Minister himself was the Chairman. How many months, how many years did we not take to weigh every single paragraph, every single sentence and every single word of that chapter? How many changes did we make at various stages of the proceedings of the Constituent Assembly? We were criticized by the people outside the Constituent Assembly that we were taking too long a time. But many of us justified this delay because we were anxious that nothing should be done hastily or on the spur of the moment. We were doing something which was unique in the annals of this country, something indeed, to which there are not many parallels in the entire civilized world. The country had attained political freedom and within a few months of attaining it, it set itself to the task of writing a Constitution and putting down everything clearly and precisely so that the people of the country belonging to all shades of opinion might have a clear idea of what exactly the country stood for. If that is so, why this indecent haste to change such a Constitution? Changes in the Constitution have been made in other countries. I was looking at the first change or amendment made to the American Constitution, and that was within three years of its first enactment. But what were the changes for? The First Amendments which were made in the American Constitution were not for curtailing freedom, not for taking away rights that had been deliberately given two and a half years ago. But every single one of those changes was made for extending the individual and the social rights of the people of the United